displacements and Sri Lankan and Tibetan refugees noted earlier, India also hosted tens of thousands of Hajongs and Chakmas from Mymensingh district in present-day Bangladesh and the Chittagong Hill Tracts. They were settled in Arunachal Pradesh and some other north-eastern states as refugees fleeing persecution in East Pakistan in the 1960s.[82] Another 10,000 Afghan refugees arrived in and around Delhi, mostly Hindus and Sikhs, fleeing the Soviet-Afghan War in the 1980s.[83] Overall, some 2,00,000 refugees live in sites and camps across India today.[84] In contrast, the number of refugees from India has been negligible though Sikh asylum seekers, fleeing violence in the 1980s, have been documented in border crossings in the Americas. A few people were also forced to leave because of intolerance towards their work, such as the writer Salman Rushdie, or intolerance towards their sexuality as Indian laws criminalize homosexuality.

India can boast of a reasonably successful record in refugee management and assimilation, even though it is not a signatory to key UN protocols on refugee issues. Given enough time, healing and compassion, some if not most are able to move out of their refugee status to build new lives and contribute to their host society. The historic acceptance of the Parsis and Baghdadi Jews in India, who fled persecution, led to flourishing contributions from those communities. India's most famous military victory in 1971, after all, was in no small measure led by a Parsi (Sam Manekshaw) and a Baghdadi Jew (J.F.R. Jacob). Indian nationalist leaders who favour the deportation of Rohingya Muslims to a regime that persecutes them would be well advised to recollect this rich Indian history in engaging with injustice and displacement. Indeed, the distinct communal bias in attitudes to refugee acceptance in recent decades when comparing the Tibetan, Sri Lankan and Burmese Rohingya cases is a matter of deep concern and a departure from the much hallowed philosophy of *atithi devo bhava*, which means 'a guest is the equivalent of God' practised in India since time immemorial.

What is paradoxical in the Indian context is that until recently international refugees or non-citizens have often got better treatment, and